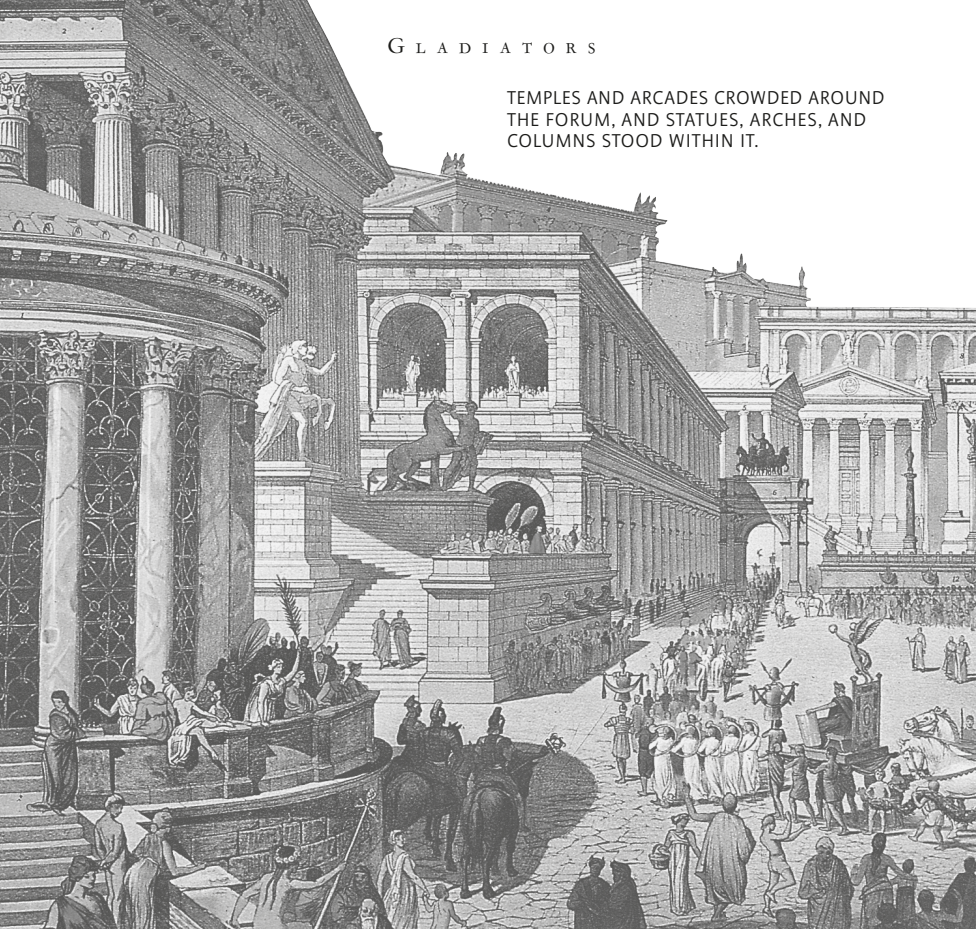


TEMPLES AND ARCADES CROWDED AROUND THE FORUM, AND STATUES, ARCHES, AND COLUMNS STOOD WITHIN IT.



Following a great fire in Rome, which destroyed the amphitheater in the Campus Martius, Emperor Vespasian built a vast new showground on the east side of the Forum. It was called the Flavian Amphitheater, and later acquired a new name ... the Colosseum.

Bigger and better

Rome continued to grow, and a list of all its buildings was made between 300 CE and 400 CE.

Here's part of what the surveyors recorded. There were 28 libraries; 8 bridges; 11 town squares (*fora*); 10 basilicas; 19 aqueducts delivering 167 million gallons (760 million liters) of water a day; 1,352 drinking fountains; 11 big bathhouses and 856 small ones; 3 theaters; 29 main roads; 2 race tracks (circuses); 2 amphitheaters; 36 triumphal arches; 37 gates in the city wall (which was 31 miles [50 km] all around);